

Staying Cool in Hot Weather

Why it matters - and what to do about it.

WHY IT MATTERS

Heat is the deadliest weather hazard. When the body can't shed heat fast enough, its core temperature climbs - straining the heart, kidneys, and brain. The risk is silent and fast: heat exhaustion can tip into life-threatening heatstroke within minutes.

Staying cool isn't comfort. It's protection.

KNOW THE WARNING SIGNS

Heat Exhaustion	Heatstroke (emergency)
Heavy sweating	Hot, dry skin or heavy sweating
Cool, clammy skin	Confusion, slurred speech
Dizziness, weakness	Body temp 40C / 104F+
Nausea, headache	Fainting, seizures

Heatstroke is a medical emergency - call for help immediately.

STAY COOL, STAY SAFE

- **Hydrate** - drink water before you feel thirsty; skip alcohol and sugary drinks.
- **Seek shade & AC** - stay indoors during the hottest hours (11am-4pm).
- **Dress light** - loose, pale, breathable clothing; a hat outdoors.
- **Slow down** - postpone hard activity to early morning or evening.
- **Cool the body** - cool showers, damp cloths, fans, feet in cool water.
- **Never leave** - children or pets in a parked car - ever.

CHECK ON OTHERS

The most vulnerable are the elderly, the very young, people who are ill or isolated, and outdoor workers. A two-minute phone call or visit can save a life.

Cool body. Clear mind. Stay safe.